

Outline the goals:

Compare the user experience of note creation and management across leading note taking platforms to identify design opportunities for a new note taking application.

Key Features:

1. New note shortcut: A quick, low-friction way to start a new note instantly, without navigating through menus.
2. Default template: Pre-built note formats (meeting notes, to-do lists, etc.) users can start from instead of a blank page.
3. Folders: A hierarchical system for grouping notes into notebooks or directories for structured organization.
4. Tags: Labels that can be attached to notes for flexible, cross-folder categorization and retrieval.
5. Nested page/linking: The ability to create sub-pages or link notes together to build connected, hierarchical knowledge.
6. Drag and drop reordering: Manually rearranging notes, pages, or sections by dragging them into a new position.
7. Text search: Finding notes by searching for matching words or phrases within their content.
8. Filters: Narrowing search or note lists by criteria like date, tag, or notebook.
9. Text formatting: Styling options such as bold, italics, headings, and font changes within a note.
10. Markdown support: Writing notes using markdown syntax (e.g., **bold**, # heading) that auto-converts to formatted text.
11. Checklists: Interactive to-do items with checkboxes that can be ticked off within a note.
12. Image/files/audios: The ability to embed or attach images, documents, or audio recordings inside a note.
13. Real time collaboration: Multiple users editing the same note simultaneously with live, synced updates.
14. Offline access: Viewing and editing notes without an internet connection, with changes syncing once reconnected.
15. Cross platform

Competitors	URL of the website	Purpose of the sites
Direct Competitor		
Notion	https://www.notion.com/	All-in-one digital workspace that combines note-taking, project management, databases, and wikis.
Microsoft Onenote	https://onenote.cloud.microsoft/	Free-form digital notebook with sections,pages and ink drawing support.
Simplenote	https://app.simplenote.com/	Lightweight, distraction-free plain text notes with instant sync.
Indirect Competitor		
Microsoft Word	https://word.cloud.microsoft/	Full featured word processor for formal document creation.
Google Doc	https://docs.google.com/	Cloud based collaborative word processing.

Feature / UX aspect	Notion	SimpleNote	Microsoft onenote	Google Docs	Microsoft words
New note shortcut	yes	yes	yes	takes more time to load the full doc	takes more time to load the full doc
Default template	yes	no	some	yes	yes
folders	pages	no	sections	drive folders	docs
tags	yes	yes	inline tagging	no	no
nested page/linking	yes	no	subpages	document tabs	basic linking
drag and drop reordering	yes	no	yes	no	no
text search	yes	yes	yes	yes	yes
filters	yes	only tags	filter by tags	Find and Replace	no
text formatting	yes	through markdown	yes	yes	yes
markdown support	yes	yes	no	yes	no
checklists	yes	yes	yes	yes	yes
image/files/audio	yes	no	yes	only image	yes
real time collaboration	yes	no	yes	yes	via onedrive
offline access	on app	yes	yes	yes	yes
cross platform	yes	yes	yes	yes	yes

Strengths/Weakness	Notion	Microsoft Onenote	Simplenote	Google Docs	Microsoft Word
Strengths	1. Extremely flexible block system 2. Databases turn notes into structured data 3. Huge template system 4. Strong web presence and sharing	1. Free 2. Free-form canvas lets users place content anywhere 3. Stylus/handwriting 4. Works offline	1. Instant reliable sync 2. Free version history 3. Distraction-free	1. Real-time collaboration 2. Zero install 3. Familiar to nearly everyone 4. Detailed version history 5. Free	1. Excellent formatting power 2. Industry-standard output 3. Templates 4. Solid offline desktop experience
Weaknesses	1. Steep learning curve 2. Pages load slowly 3. Offline mode unreliable	1. Sync conflicts on shared notebooks 2. UI inconsistent across Windows/Mac/mobile 3. Tag search is weak 4. Free-form canvas can become messy	1. Plain text only : no images, tables, or rich formatting 2. No folders 3. Unsuitable for complex or visual notes	1. Not designed for note management: no tags, no internal linking, Drive folder organization is external 2. Sluggish with many docs	1. Poor fit for quick notes: heavy startup, file-management burden, no tagging; expensive 2. Collaboration clunkier than Docs